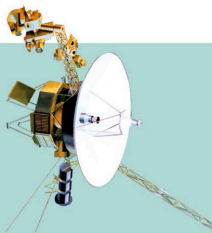




FOCUS ON... PLUTONIUM

Isotopes (forms) of plutonium are radioactive and produce heat. This is converted to electricity for various uses.



▲ Deep space probes, such as Voyager 1, use plutonium batteries as a source of power.



▲ Plutonium was used in early nuclear bombs – one such bomb was used on Japan in World War II.



▲ One form of plutonium is used as nuclear fuel for generating electricity.

Plutonium

94
Pu

The actinide plutonium was named after Pluto, the dwarf planet. It was the first artificial element to be manufactured in large amounts. It can be created from uranium in nuclear reactors.

ATOMIC MASS (244)

STATE Solid

DISCOVERY 1940 (team led by Glenn T Seaborg)



“Fat Man”, the nuclear bomb dropped over Nagasaki, Japan, in 1945, contained about 6.5 kg (14.3 lb) of plutonium fuel.

**Chunk of uraninite,
an ore of plutonium**

